



18 COOL THINGS YOU CAN ACCOMPLISH WITH BLOCKCHAIN

Blockchain technology is often synonymous in people's minds with cryptocurrency, primarily Bitcoin. However, this misplaced notion is changing at a rapid rate since innovators and startups are constantly coming up with new, real-world uses of the technology. The decentralisation and transparency that comes with blockchain can cause massive disruptions in multiple industries and more and more people are beginning to notice this. We list out eighteen cool things you can do with blockchain now or will be able to in the coming years.

01 PAY LOWER FOR CHARGING CARS

Currently, when you charge your electric car, you pay for the amount of time you have spent at the charging station. The billing system in place right now cannot calculate the exact electricity you have utilised to charge the car as of now. By connecting electric cars' charging stations to



Why pay extra when you can pay for what you consume with blockchain?

Numerous tech companies and innovators are testing out possible uses of blockchain in areas outside of cryptocurrency. Here are 18 cool things you will be able to accomplish with Blockchain now or in the coming years.

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a blockchain, the station will be able to handle user authentication, payment processing and loyalty rewards assigned. RWE, a German energy company, has connected hundreds of electric vehicles' charging stations to Ethereum's public blockchain which lets the user pay in micro-transactional slices - paying exactly for the energy they consumed.

02 SHARE ELECTRICITY WITH NEIGHBOURS

Blockchain enables people to purchase and sell renewable energy to their neighbours. You can share solar power with your community if you have an excess of it through blockchain. This power will also be cheaper to acquire owing to the proximity between neighbours. Solar panels calculate the number of electrons generated by the heat and feed these numbers into a blockchain. The technology then allows you to have a power trading platform where you can exchange locally generated electricity and have transparency about the source of all the electricity generated. Companies such as MicroGrid in Brooklyn, New York and PowerLedger in Australia

have already made considerable headway here.

03 LET YOUR APPLIANCES PAY FOR THINGS

The idea of a blockchain which registers household appliances at the point of manufacture and has a sort of autonomous identity is a powerful one. The appliance's autonomous identity lets it purchase items for its use - a washing machine buying detergent. IBM's Autonomous Decentralised Peer-to-Peer-Telemetry (ADEPT) research was one of the first IoT-Blockchain proposals back in 2015. This even allows appliances to control their own budgets for the month so that these machines don't go overboard hoarding an item they need to use.

04 RENT A CAR

Usually, users need to go through a rather complicated rental procedure to lease a car which involves showing their driver's license and filling up forms and documents. Car leasing companies also face issues with this process since most of the information about their customers, vehicles and transactions are not